

Child care is the work that makes all work possible.

POP is a coalition of child care providers, parents, unions, policy advocates and communities organizing to win thriving wages for the providers who are delivering NY universal child care.

$37,675
median pay for a New York child care educator, lower than 96% of jobs in the state

$6.01
median hourly pay for NYC Family Child Care providers, after accounting for the costs of running programs at home

57%
of New York child care programs short-staffed, with well over 20,000 families on the waitlist for child care assistance

Our work so far



Seats at the table

Providers Organized for Power has secured a co-governance table with NYC officials and is piloting programs for providers and ensuring accountability for policies that affect the workforce.



Wins for families

The State budget added a historic $1.2 billion for the Child Care Assistance Program (CCAP), and in October NYC began moving 10,000 children off the voucher waitlist.



Legislators on record

In preparation for the 2027 legislative session, POP providers, unions and advocates secured elected officials' commitment to stand with us on four principles for pay justice.

Next: December 2, 2026. We launch the statewide Pay Our Providers campaign in Albany, Buffalo and New York City. **See reverse for details and to join us!**

How we work

Policy follows organizing. POP's providers, unions, community organizations and parent groups shape and lead the campaign through organizing committees, co-governance, and leadership.

Providers in all settings. Family child care providers, center-based teachers and assistants, and providers in the informal sector -- the people who do the work drive the agenda.

Statewide. From NYC to Buffalo, we're building provider and parent leadership across the state, because universal child care means thriving wages for all New Yorkers.

PROVIDERS ORGANIZED FOR POWER

Empire State Campaign for Child Care · UFT · Organized Independent Childcare Educators CSEA Voice · DC 37 AFSCME AFL-CIO · Day Care Council of New York · New York Union Child Care Coalition · ECE On The Move · Las Doñas

New York Communities for Change · Make the Road New York · Citizen Action of New York · AaQaEe Alliance for Quality Education · Consortium for Worker Education · ILR Worker Institute · the action lab

popchildcare.org
Providers Organized for Power

info@popchildcare.org
@popchildcare

Pass pay justice legislation this session & fully fund the road to universal child care

New Yorkers deserve universal child care -- but we must stop building it on poverty wages. NY State must **enact policies this session that guarantee child care providers thriving wages** and a salary scale that recognizes their experience. The State must commit to fully funding the programs that will get us to universal child care and to filling the provider pay gap so that families aren't left footing the bill.

PAY OUR PROVIDERS · CAMPAIGN LAUNCH

Pay Justice: Make thriving wages the law and recognize child care work as a profession.

$1.8B est.

POP calls for a statewide salary scale and career ladder that starts with guaranteeing living wages for all providers and ensures meaningful increases based on role, credentials, and experience. All providers in all settings across the state will be included.

Universal Child Care: End the waitlists by fully funding programs families need.

$1.2B est.

While we Pay Our Providers living wages, we must also fully fund the programs that are already critical to hundreds of thousands of New Yorkers, including the Child Care Assistance Program (CCAP). Full funding means that no eligible family is waitlisted.

What you stand for when you stand with POP:

1. **A statewide salary scale and career ladder**
   Set in State law, with raises for credentials and experience, plus cost-of-living increases.
2. **Subsidies and payment reform**
   Rate increases and subsidies to ensure the cost of thriving wages doesn't fall on providers.
3. **Worker voice and bargaining**
   Standards for the workforce across the state to empower organizing and collective bargaining.
4. **Sustainable financing**
   Dedicated, sustainable, progressive revenue that gets overdue pay justice to providers fast.

Sign on to the campaign!

ELECTED OFFICIALS

Become a POP Champion

- Endorse POP's demands
- Champion pay justice legislation and full funding this session
- Join us to launch our campaign on December 2

popny.org/champion

ORGANIZATIONS

Endorse the Campaign

- Show that your organization stands with providers as NY delivers universal child care
- Outreach to your members and help mobilize a broad group of stakeholders

popny.org/endorse

EVERYONE

Join the Campaign

- Sign up and show up
- Join us in NYC, Albany, or Buffalo for our campaign launch, aka a birthday party for child care champion Shirley Chisholm

popny.org/dec2

info@popchildcare.org
@popchildcare